MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume X | Issue 1 | Winter 2020



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MTN. VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION 2020 VISION Workshop

ABOUT THE WORKSHOP

What is the future of local history in Mountain View?

As we enter a new decade, the Mountain View Historical Association Board of Directors invites members to join us for a workshop where we will work together to chart the future of our organization. The workshop will be an opportunity to do a deep dive into our organization's mission, goals, structure, and future projects.

This workshop will serve as our quarterly membership meeting for winter 2020. We hope you'll join us for an engaging and interactive afternoon focused on how our organization can best serve the Mountain View community now and into the future. Lunch will be provided to those who RSVP by February 9.

OUR FACILITATOR

We are very happy to have Mike Kasperzak volunteer his time and professional expertise as facilitator and mediator for our 2020 Vision Workshop. Mike will lead us through a series of interactive discussion exercises designed to get the conversation and ideas flowing.

As a lifetime member of the MVHA and former Mountain View mayor and councilmember, Mike is deeply plugged-in to the past, present, and future of Mountain View and is excited to help the MVHA develop our vision for the future of the organization.



Mike Kasperzak

RSVP AT: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com OR CALL: (650) 903-6890

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 16, 2020 ● 11:00 A.M. TO 2:00 P.M. ● ODD FELLOWS LODGE, 206 CASTRO STREET, MTN. VIEW, CA

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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In Memoriam

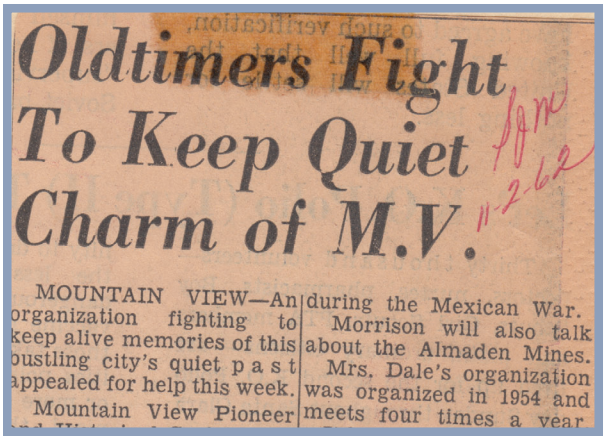
Paul Arata
1927–2019

Wallace Erichsen
1919–2019

News & Notes

President's Message

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President



Oldtimers Fight To Keep Quiet Charm of M.V.

11-2-62

MOUNTAIN VIEW—An organization fighting to keep alive memories of this bustling city's quiet past appealed for help this week.

Mountain View Pioneer during the Mexican War. Morrison will also talk about the Almaden Mines. Mrs. Dale's organization was organized in 1954 and meets four times a year

In 1962, the *San Jose Mercury News* ran an article about the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Society titled "Oldtimers Fight to Keep Quiet Charm of M.V." The article opens by stating, "An organization fighting to keep alive memories of this bustling city's quiet past appealed for help this week." It goes on to state, "Rapid growth of apartments, housing tracts, shopping centers, and industry in Mountain View threatens to wipe out any sign of the area's colorful history" and mentions that the MVHA had "launched a membership drive to gain new recruits for the cause of research, marking, and, in some cases, preservation of sites and structures." The article notes that the MVHA meets four times a year.

In the ensuing 58 years since the article was written, Mountain View has experienced remarkable change. But the MVHA, for better or worse, has remained pretty much the same. Although we've dropped the word "Pioneer" from our name and are now a mix of both "oldtimers" and "newcomers," we're still a small organization trying to preserve local history in a city defined by rapid growth and change.

But as we enter the 2020s, it's become increasingly clear to the MVHA's Board of Directors that the time is ripe to both reflect on our organization's past and chart a new course for its future. Mountain View is thriving; thousands of new people have moved in, many eager to learn about the history of their new hometown. But at the same time, gentrification has rippled through every neighborhood, displacing long-time residents and making it harder to retain members. Social media has made it much easier to share local history, but online platforms have lessened demand for in-person gatherings or officially joining clubs. Case in point, we have 1,400 followers on Facebook but our actual membership now hovers around just 250. Attendance at our events used to have a sizeable group of reliable stalwarts, members who'd attend every gathering regardless of the topic or theme, but many of those folks are no longer with us. For many years, the MVHA was driven by a mission to build a museum like our counterparts in Sunnyvale and Los Altos have built. But our early 2000s museum proposal lacked the support needed to become a reality, and we've never been able to truly restore the wind to our sails ever since.

With these factors in mind, our Board has decided to start the year by turning our winter membership meeting into a workshop where we'll have the time and space to roll up our sleeves and discuss the future of the MVHA and how our mission, our goals, our events, and our projects can adapt to the ever-changing city of Mountain View. We welcome interested members to join us. This will be an interactive, facilitated session, so please come with an open mind and any ideas you have for the future of the MVHA. I hope to see you there!

—Nick



Retro Mtn. View

MVHA's Online Clothing Shop Now Open!

Looking to add some hometown pride to your wardrobe? Then check out the MVHA's online clothing shop where we're selling designs inspired by local history! All proceeds go to supporting the MVHA and our mission to preserve and share Mountain View's history. Visit the shop at:

teespring.com/stores/retromv

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 9/2/2019: $23,472.59
- Income: $203.33
- Expenses: $905.87

Checking Account Balance as of 1/24/2020: $22,645.86

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/2/2019: $60,229.09
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 1/24/2020: $60,321.66

Searching for Women's Suffrage Stories

By Pamela Baird
MVHA Member

Do you have any photos, memorabilia, pamphlets, articles, etc. related to the campaign for women's suffrage in the Mountain View area (1896-1920)? If so, the Los Altos Mountain View League of Woman Voters would like to get in touch with you! The League is partnering with the Los Altos History Museum to create an exhibit commemorating the 100th anniversary of women getting the right to vote in the United States. Please contact me at (650) 740-4847 or at pamkbassoc@jps.net to help us create what is sure to be a fascinating exhibit.

Heritage Park Happenings

By Mary Kay Marinovich
MVHA Director-at-Large



On September 26, 2019, the 2nd Annual Mountain View Harvest History Festival was held at Heritage Park on Rengstorff Avenue. Children explored the garden, visited Immigrant House, and reveled in a sea of bubbles. The event featured music by bluegrass band The Stragglyrs and "Greenie" a '57 Chevy used in the Marinovich apricot and cherry orchard in the 50's–60's. Mountain View Historical Association was there answering questions about our local history.



This past fall the MVHA was asked by the Khan Lab School to help teach students about the history of Mountain View. As part of this partnership, I was asked to give a tour of Heritage Park on October 24; the first guided tour given by yours truly at the park! About 25 students, three teachers, and six parents joined me for the tour. Students learned about the history of the land and Mountain View's agrarian past, visited the bees, and checked out Soil & Water's garden. They also got to see the future site of the Girl Scout Butterfly Garden. Of course, we spent a lot of time showing the students Immigrant House! The children were fascinated by the period-appropriate ice box and stove in the kitchen as well as the steamer trunk and the bed in the front room. The kids also wanted to know where the residents of the little house went to the bathroom, so I had to explain the concept of outhouses to them. So many sweet moments watching all the amazing young students taking everything in!



Veterans Memorial Interpretive Sign Installed

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President

We are very pleased to share the news that the Mountain View Veterans Memorial interpretive sign was installed at Eagle Park in time for the Veterans Day ceremony on November 11, 2019. The newly installed interpretive sign was co-funded and designed by the MVHA and is the culmination of a partnership with the Mountain View Veterans Memorial Committee that began in 2014. Special thanks to Cindy and Ken Newman from the Veterans Memorial Committee! Next time you're in Eagle Park be sure to check out the new sign.

MV High Eagles Monument Approved

By Susan Metcalf
Special Contributor

Forty-five years ago, the Mountain View High School Eagles varsity football team won the Santa Clara Valley Athletic League and then beat the odds to win the Central Coast Section (CCS) championship. And on January 16, the Mountain View Parks and Recreation Commission accepted a donation for a monument dedicated to this remarkable team and special moment in Mountain View's history.



The Cinderella team was small and, like the school, racially diverse. No one expected the team to win. It was a landmark moment in the history of the city. The team brought the community together, game by game. Many families attended games leading up to CCS even though they didn't have athletes on the team. Proponents of the monument say these are important memories and ones that should not be forgotten.

The monument will be located in Eagle Park and flanked by two benches facing what used to be the scoreboard on the Wendall Grubb football field. It's hoped that residents and park goers reminisce while enjoying the grassy expanse that once was a football field of dreams and ambition. The monument will be made of gray granite with laser engraving that should withstand wind and adverse weather conditions for the next 500 years. The team's motto, "You Gotta Believe," will be prominent in the engraving. The monument will feature the players and coaches' name as well as the "very serious" MVHS cartoon Eagle.

The monument will serve several purposes. It will provide old and new Mountain View residents an opportunity to celebrate Mountain View's history and cultural diversity. It will acknowledge the legacy of Mountain View High School, on Castro Street, and recognize some remarkable young football players who overcame adversity to prevail. Most importantly, it will inspire future generations of Mountain View youth, "to believe."

The Mountain View community is invited to contribute to the funding of the monument and benches. Visit: gofundme.com/f/monument-campaign.

Remembering the Erichsens





Ruth Job (MVHS Class of 1939) & Wallace Erichsen's (MVHS Class of 1938) Senior Portraits

President's Note: Late last year we received word of the passing of one of our most dedicated members, Wallace "Wally" Erichsen. Wally was preceded in death by Ruth Job Erichsen, his wife of 78 years, who passed away in 2017. In honor of these two long-time MVHA Members, we're sharing an abbreviated version of their obituaries here.

Wallace (1919–2019) and Ruth Job Erichsen (1921–2017) were proud Mountain View natives and Mountain View High School sweethearts who eloped the summer after Ruth graduated. A formal wedding was celebrated with family at the chapel at Stanford University when Wallace completed his degree there. The couple enjoyed 78 years of marriage together, raising a family and living their entire lives in Mountain View and Los Altos.



Ruth & Wallace Erichsen

After earning his undergraduate and master's degree in metallurgical engineering, Wallace was employed by Joshua Hendy Ironworks which later became Westinghouse, in Sunnyvale. As manager of material and processes engineering at Westinghouse, Wallace developed alloys that were designed specifically for special projects as well as large government contracts. Over the 39-year span of his career, Wallace was instrumental in manufacturing many notable projects such as the Tullahoma Wind Tunnel, "the world's largest machine." Ruth was the epitome of a homemaker, raising four children and enjoying seven grandchildren as well as seven great-grandchildren. She was accomplished in all handwork, sewing, knitting and especially counted cross-stitch.



Wallace (right) shows Bob Weaver (left) the MVHA plaque honoring his friend, City Historian Barbara Kinchen at the plaque's unveiling in 2018.

Wallace and Ruth were long-time members of the Mountain View Historical Association and familiar faces at our meetings and events for decades. Wallace took on a variety of leadership roles in the organization over the years, including serving as the organization's president. In the early 1990s, he led the Association's efforts to preserve and restore the historic Adobe Building by spearheading the successful "Save the Adobe" campaign. He was also a strong supporter of the MVHA's efforts to build a museum in the early 2000s. Most recently, Wallace donated the funds needed for the MVHA to create a plaque honoring the life of City Historian Barbara Kinchen in 2018.

Wallace and Ruth will be missed by the MVHA, and we express our heartfelt condolences to their family and friends.

From Bankers to Odd Fellows

Our 2020 Vision Workshop will take place in the International Order of Odd Fellows (IOOF) Lodge at 206 Castro Street. Mountain View's chapter of IOOF was established in 1876, making it one of the city's oldest organizations. The IOOF lodge was originally built c. 1913 as Mountain View's branch of the First National Bank. The bank's original Neoclassical facade resembled a Greek temple, with four large Ionic columns that reached to a second-story pediment. The style was popular for banks at the time, evoking stability and permanence. The building remained home to the bank until 1947. In the 1950s its facade was stripped away, leaving the plain exterior we see today. It was purchased by IOOF in 1970 and has been the order's lodge ever since. The MVHA thanks IOOF for opening up their building to us for our workshop on February 16!



FALL 2020 EVENT

Back to the Eagle Shack



The Mountain View High jazz combo Fifth Edition treated guests to live music during the first half of the event. A special surprise was when the group debuted a new arrangement of the old Mountain View High School Alma mater anthem.



Eugene Sharp spoke about the history of the Eagle Shack, recounted memories of his time playing at the Shack with his band, the Melody Makers, and treated us to a brief clarinet solo.



Mark & Gloria Perry dancing to the tunes of Mountain View High's Fifth Edition



MVHA Membership Chair Lisa Garcia presented a slideshow talk on the history of Mountain View High School.



Multiple generations gathered to attend this special event.



Attendees enjoyed a delicious spread of catered food!



Historical artifacts from the Mountain View High School Castro Street campus were on display, with custom decorations by Gloria Perry.



A special thank you to Eugene and Nancy Sharp for sponsoring this event!

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

Membership as of January 25, 2020

Honored Members	1
Life Members	116
Family Members	63
Single Members	69
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**249**

A warm welcome to new member, Gary Spears!

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.

Join the Parade!



The MVHA is looking for members to represent our organization in the 62nd annual Downtown Mountain View Spring Parade. The parade will take place on Castro Street from 10:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m on Saturday, April 25. If you are the owner of a classic car and would be interested in driving members of our parade contingent, please contact us!

Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org to sign-up today.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. You can also join and renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

☐ New Membership

☐ Membership Renewal

☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*

☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*

☐ Life Membership: *$200*

Name(s): _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

E-mail: _____

☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

☐ *I'd like a print-edition subscription of the newsletter. (To save paper and costs, the default subscription is digital emailed newsletter.)*

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Thank you!

WINTER/SPRING

February 16

Sunday 11:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.

MVHA 2020 Vision Workshop + MVHA Winter Meeting

206 Castro Street, Mtn. View

Please note new date and location! See page 1 for more info.

March 11

Wednesday 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.

MVHA Winter/Spring Board Meeting

M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.

All interested members welcome to attend!

April 25

Saturday 10:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.

Mountain View Spring Parade

Castro Street - Downtown Mtn. View

We are looking for volunteers to be in our parade contingent, see page 7 for details.

May 3

Sunday 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.

MVHA Spring Event & Meeting

Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd.

Details in our next newsletter!

Looking Back: Photos from the Archive



MVHA Members pose for a photo after dedicating our first historical marker in 1957.

Since its founding, the MVHA has helped install historical placards, plaques and markers throughout the city. The first historical marker was installed on March 3, 1957, on the west side of the 500 block of Castro Street, marking the cemetery grounds given by Maria Trinidad Peralta de Castro to the Cumberland Presbyterian Church as a "burying ground for all religions." The former cemetery is now Pioneer Park. When the park was built, unclaimed remains were reburied on-site. Our original marker was eventually relocated to the park's Church Street edge. Our newest historical marker was installed in Eagle Park in November 2019! For more information on that marker, see page 4.

EST. 1954

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

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Mountain View, CA 94042

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